NP Hiring

2026 SALARY DATA

Nurse Practitioner Salary Guide

National median **$132,300** per year (BLS OEWS, Nurse Practitioners (29-1171), median annual wage, May 2025). For nurse practitioners: pay by experience level, practice setting, and specialty premium, plus what to check before you negotiate. State-by-state figures update daily at nphiring.com/salary-guide.

Figures verified 2026-10-06 · Published by NP Hiring (nphiring.com) · Free companion to nphiring.com/salary-guide

$132,300

NATIONAL MEDIAN

BLS OEWS, Nurse Practitioners (29-1171), median annual wage, May 2025

41%

PROJECTED JOB GROWTH

BLS Employment Projections, Nurse Practitioners (2025 to 2035)

27 states + DC

FULL PRACTICE AUTHORITY

AANP State Practice Environment

100 million+

IN PRIMARY-CARE SHORTAGE AREAS

HRSA Bureau of Health Workforce, Designated HPSA Quarterly Summary (primary care)

Quick Answer: NP Salary in 2026

The median nurse practitioner salary is **$132,300 per year** (BLS OEWS, Nurse Practitioners (29-1171), median annual wage, May 2025). Half of NPs earn more and half earn less. The lowest paid 10% earn less than **$101,340**, and the highest paid 10% earn more than **$174,420**.

Every salary range and percentage premium in this guide other than the cited national median is NP Hiring's own editorial estimate, compiled from the roles posted on nphiring.com. Treat them as a starting point for negotiation, not as survey data.

Methodology & Sources

Every national figure in this guide traces to a named public source; every posting-derived figure traces to live listings on NP Hiring. Live inventory counts come from 491 active NP postings with a disclosed salary on NP Hiring (snapshot 2026-10-13); posting data updates daily. This guide reports those counts and the board's published salary-validation bands rather than a frozen state-by-state wage table (see “Salary by Location”).

- BLS OEWS, Nurse Practitioners (29-1171), median annual wage, May 2025: `https://www.bls.gov/oes/current/oes291171.htm` (as of 2025-05)
- BLS Employment Projections, Nurse Practitioners (2025 to 2035): `https://www.bls.gov/emp/tables/fastest-growing-occupations.htm` (as of 2026-08)
- AANP State Practice Environment: `https://www.aanp.org/advocacy/state/state-practice-environment` (as of 2026)
- HRSA Bureau of Health Workforce, Designated HPSA Quarterly Summary (primary care): `https://data.hrsa.gov/Default/GenerateHPSAQuarterlyReport` (as of 2026-09)

Every salary range and percentage premium in this guide other than the cited national median is NP Hiring's own editorial estimate, compiled from the roles posted on nphiring.com. Treat them as a starting point for negotiation, not as survey data. Individual offers vary by employer, location, credentials, and experience.

© 2026 Akari Labs LLC · nphiring.com/salary-guide

SALARY BY LOCATION

Where NP Pay Comes From, and Where to Look It Up

As of 2026-10-13, NP Hiring lists **491** active NP postings with a disclosed salary, from **65** hiring employers across **43** states, out of 763 published openings in total.

Why this guide does not print a state-by-state wage table. State pay on NP Hiring is derived from live postings that change every day, and the disclosed-salary pool mixes W-2 salaries with annualized contract and locum hourly rates, so a snapshot frozen into a PDF would go stale and would overstate typical pay. The **state-by-state table updates daily and is free** at **nphiring.com/salary-guide**, with a dedicated page per state. For an authoritative national wage benchmark, use the federal figure cited throughout this guide: **$132,300** (BLS OEWS, Nurse Practitioners (29-1171), median annual wage, May 2025).

NP Hiring Salary-Validation Bands

These are the board's **ingestion thresholds**, not a measurement of NP pay. Every salary an employer posts is checked against them before the listing goes live: numbers outside the outer bounds are rejected as data-entry errors, and numbers outside the middle band are flagged for a human to look at. They are set deliberately wide so that legitimate edge cases are not thrown away, which means they describe what this board will *accept*, not what a typical NP earns. For a measured wage figure, use the federal benchmark above (**$132,300**, BLS OEWS, Nurse Practitioners (29-1171), median annual wage, May 2025); for market ranges, use the experience, setting and specialty tables in the next section.

BAND	RANGE	HOW THE BOARD USES IT
W-2 annual salary	**$60,000 to $400,000**	Accept/reject bounds for a posted W-2 figure. The ceiling is set high enough to admit the best-paid advanced-practice listings (CRNA-level roles in high-cost markets), so it is an upper limit on accepted data, not the top of the NP market
Outlier-review band	**$110,000 to $170,000**	A posted salary outside this band is flagged for manual review before publishing. It is a screening threshold carried over from the board's configuration, not a survey, and not a claim about where most offers land
Contract / 1099 hourly	**$40 to $350 per hour**	Validated as an hourly rate: do not annualize it to compare against a W-2 offer

A $350/hour contract rate multiplies out to $728,000 on paper, but carries no benefits, no paid time off, no employer payroll-tax contribution, and no guaranteed hours. Compare contract rates to contract rates.

SALARY BREAKDOWN

What Impacts Your Earnings

Every salary range and percentage premium in this guide other than the cited national median is NP Hiring's own editorial estimate, compiled from the roles posted on nphiring.com. Treat them as a starting point for negotiation, not as survey data.

By Experience Level

EXPERIENCE	SALARY RANGE	TYPICAL ROLES
New Grad (0-1 yr)	**$95,000 to $115,000**	Staff NP, Outpatient Clinic
Early Career (1-3 yrs)	**$110,000 to $130,000**	Staff NP, Telehealth Provider
Mid-Career (3-7 yrs)	**$125,000 to $150,000**	Senior NP, Team Lead
Experienced (7-15 yrs)	**$150,000 to $180,000**	Clinical Director, Supervisor
Expert (15+ yrs)	**$180,000 to $250,000+**	Director, Consultant, Private Practice

By Practice Setting

SETTING	SALARY RANGE	NOTES
Private Practice (Owner)	**$180,000 to $300,000+**	Highest earning potential, requires business skills
Travel / Locum Tenens	**$150,000 to $250,000**	Includes housing, travel, higher hourly rates
Telehealth / Remote	**$130,000 to $180,000**	Growing rapidly, flexible schedules
Outpatient Clinic	**$120,000 to $160,000**	Most common setting, steady patient load
Hospital / Inpatient	**$115,000 to $150,000**	Often includes shift differentials, benefits
Community Health (FQHC)	**$100,000 to $130,000**	May qualify for loan forgiveness programs

Specialty Premiums

SPECIALTY	PREMIUM VS. BASELINE	NOTES
Acute Care / Hospitalist	**+10-20%**	AGACNP certification, hospital demand
Psychiatric-Mental Health	**+10-20%**	PMHNP-BC certification, provider shortage
Emergency / Urgent Care	**+10-20%**	Dynamic environment, flexible scheduling
Dermatology / Aesthetics	**+10-25%**	Procedure-driven, cash-pay revenue
Gerontology / Palliative	**+5-10%**	Growing aging population
Private Practice (Owner)	**+20-40%**	Higher risk, no benefits
Rural / Underserved	**+10-15%**	Often includes loan repayment

Full Practice Authority

27 states + DC grant FPA (AANP State Practice Environment). Practice authority is a legal classification, not a pay scale. It decides which ways of earning are open to you in that state.

✓ Full Practice Authority

- Own and bill under your own practice
- Independent 1099 and telehealth work
- Several states first require a transition period

Restricted / Reduced

- Most require an agreement, supervision or delegation first
- That agreement is usually a paid one
- Several offer a route out after a set amount of experience

MAXIMIZE YOUR PAY

Factors Affecting NP Salary, and How to Negotiate

Six levers that move NP compensation. Evergreen guidance: the same factor breakdown published on nphiring.com/salary-guide.



Geographic Location

States with higher cost of living and greater demand (CA, NY, MA) typically offer 20-40% higher salaries than rural areas.



Experience Level

Entry-level NPs start around $95-115k. With 5+ years experience, salaries can reach $150-180k or more.



Practice Setting

Private practice and telehealth positions often pay more than hospital or community health settings.



Employment Type

1099 contractors and travel NPs often earn 20-50% more than W2 employees, though without traditional benefits.



Specialization

Subspecialties like acute care, emergency, psychiatric-mental health, or dermatology can command premium pay (+10-25%).



Negotiation

NPs who negotiate can often secure 5-15% higher starting salaries plus signing bonuses ($5,000-$30,000).

Cite This Guide

NP Hiring. "2026 NP Salary Guide: Nurse Practitioner Pay by State." NP Hiring, 2026, nphiring.com/salary-guide.

Media inquiries and custom data requests: press@nphiring.com

Find Your Next High-Paying NP Job

Browse current openings with disclosed salaries, filter by state, setting, and work type, and set free job alerts at **nphiring.com/jobs**. The live salary guide, updated daily, is always free at **nphiring.com/salary-guide**.

© 2026 Akari Labs LLC · nphiring.com/salary-guide